# Even Step

## Our December 2026 link — what changes for you, in plain English

A proposal for discussion · CEA link · 26 weeks · code ES-26-T5

# The short version

Five things to take away if you remember nothing else

| 35h | 5 | 14 | 8 of 13 | 30 min |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **the contracted week, as now** | **most days in a row** | **full weekends off a year** | **shift times you already work** | **off every closing shift** |
| no extra hours | up to 7 · today 7–9 | today 10 · 7 in 26 | 5 new ones | up to 1 hour |

**Same hours, shorter closers, nothing over 8h 30m Monday to Saturday, and never more than five days in a row, cover weeks aside.**

# Why the link has to change

Nobody is changing it for the sake of it

### A new timetable in December 2026

More trains, at new times — the link has to follow them.

### More of us on the link

It grows from 20 weeks to 26, so six more colleagues join it.

### New staffing levels

At least 10 on a Sunday, and more at the close and at 22:00. We also aim for 14 on a Saturday.

### The ticket office in fixed pairs

Two early and two late, on the same shifts, every day.

**The change is coming whatever we do — the question is which version we want.**

# Will I work more?

The first thing everyone asks

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Contracted hours a week | 35h | **35h** |
| Contracted days at work a week | 4.20 | **4.19** |
| Contracted days at work a year | 219.0 | **218.6** |

**No. The same 35-hour week on average; weeks run 25h 30m–41h 30m Monday to Saturday (today 25h 10m–43h 50m), and two more days a year are Saturdays.**

# Will my basic pay change?

Basic pay follows your contracted hours

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Contracted hours a week | 35h | **35h** |
| Saturdays a year, at time and a quarter | 26 | **28** |
| Sunday overtime to share — each, a year | 21 | **20** |

**No: basic pay stays the same. Premium and overtime pay come to about £250 a year less, gross, if you work your share of Sundays.**

# Will my shifts be longer?

Every closing shift gets shorter — the average goes up about two minutes

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Weekday closer — starts 15:45, not 15:15 | 8h 40m | **8h 10m** |
| Saturday closer — starts 15:45, not 14:45 | 9h 10m | **8h 10m** |
| Sunday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:30 | 8h 55m | **8h 10m** |
| Longest shift anywhere | 9h 10m | **9h 00m** |
| Average shift | 8h 14m | **8h 16m** |

**Every closing shift is 30 to 60 minutes shorter; nothing Monday to Saturday runs over 8h 30m, and nothing at all over 9 hours.**

# Will I finish late more often?

3 more a year at 23:00 or later (42, today 39); 16 more at 22:00 or later (94, today 78)

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Finishing at 23:00 or later — each, a year | 39 | **42** |
| Finishing at 22:00 or later — each, a year | 78 | **94** |
| Starting at 06:20 — each, a year | 62 | **60** |
| Shortest gap between two shifts | 12h 30m | **14h 35m** |

**More people stay on after 22:00 under the December staffing; the three more at 23:00 or later are the fewest the rules allow.**

# Will I know the times?

13 shift times in all — 8 of them you already work

### You work these today (8)

| | |
|---|---|
| 06:20–13:45 | 07:15–15:45 |
| 06:20–14:00 | 08:00–16:30 |
| 06:20–14:20 | 14:00–22:30 |
| 06:20–14:50 | 14:30–22:00 |

### New times (5)

- Closers start later: 30 minutes on weekdays, an hour on Saturdays, 45 minutes on Sundays
- A new weekday late, 12:15–20:30
- On Sundays: a 9-hour early, 09:00–18:00, and the ticket-office late, 14:30–22:30

**Fewer shift times than today (13, not 18) — and no early Monday to Saturday is new.**

# Rest and weekends

The biggest improvement over today

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Full weekends off, about a year | 10 | **14** |
| Most days worked in a row | 7 (up to 9) | **5 (up to 7)** |
| Rest-day breaks of two days or more | 13 of 17 | **22 of 26** |
| Shortest gap between two shifts | 12h 30m | **14h 35m** |
| Weeks on one shift time, Monday to Friday | 7 of 16 | **18 of 21** |

**14 full weekends off a year, at most five weeks apart, and never more than five days in a row, cover weeks aside.**

# Your 26 weeks at a glance

The green bars are the full weekends off; where you start is decided later




**Blocks of earlies or lates up to 5 weeks, 7 if the cover weeks go the same way; a full weekend off comes round at least every 5 weeks.**

# Booking leave

What 14 days of annual leave buys you, with Sundays off

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Days off in a row — best place to book | 30 | **28** |
| Days off in a row — on average | 23.4 | **23.4** |
| Days off in a row — worst place | 19 | **20** |
| Leave for four full weeks off, at best | 14 | **15** |

**Best stretch 28 days, not 30; four full weeks off in a row, Sunday to Saturday, costs 15 days' leave, not 14. Average the same, worst a day better.**

# More staff on the floor

More people rostered every day, and more at the open and the close on most days

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| On duty on a weekday | 11–12 | **15** |
| On duty on a Saturday / Sunday | 10 / 8 | **14 / 10** |
| Fewest rostered on the floor | 2 | **3** |
| Avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside | 4 (up to 5) | **0 (up to 1)** |

**At least three rostered on the floor, and no avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside.**

# The honest trade-offs

Nothing is free — here is what it costs

### Five new shift times to learn

Three shorter versions of today's lates, a new 8h 15m late and the 9-hour Sunday early.

### Earlies or lates in longer runs

Up to 5 weeks of one kind, 7 if the cover weeks go the same way (today 2, up to 3).

### Four weeks off: 15 days' leave, not 14

The least leave for four complete weeks off in a row, Sunday to Saturday.

### Two more Saturdays a year

28 a year each, today 26 — fourteen on a Saturday, shared across 26 lines.

### More late finishes

42 a year each at 23:00 or later (today 39), and 94 at 22:00 or later (today 78).

### Fewer early finishes

10 a year each finish before 14:00 (today 26).

**None of these is hidden: every figure here is worked out from the rota.**

# At a glance

Same hours and days, shorter closers, more weekends off, fewer days in a row

| | Today | Even Step |
|---|---|---|
| Contracted hours a week | 35h | 35h |
| Contracted days at work a year | 219.0 | 218.6 |
| Average shift · longest shift | 8h 14m · 9h 10m | 8h 16m · 9h 00m |
| **Closing shift: weekday · Saturday · Sunday** | 8h 40m · 9h 10m · 8h 55m | **8h 10m · 8h 10m · 8h 10m** |
| **Full weekends off, about a year** | 10 | **14** |
| **Most days worked in a row** | 7 (up to 9) | **5 (up to 7)** |
| Shortest gap between two shifts | 12h 30m | 14h 35m |
| Different shift times | 18 | 13 (8 you know) |
| On duty weekday · Saturday · Sunday | 11–12 · 10 · 8 | 15 · 14 · 10 |
| Avoidable fatigue warnings, cover weeks aside | 4 (up to 5) | 0 (up to 1) |

**The costs: more late finishes and longer runs of earlies or lates.**

# What happens next

1. Look at the full proposal sheet — page 3 shows every week of the link
2. Tell us what worries you, even if it is small
3. Your feedback goes to the managers with the proposal